

SONS & DAUGHTERS

EMPOWERMENT 2021

(Talk about Abraham being the Father of the Jewish nation)

This was the model that Jesus followed – ***“Our Father which art in Heaven...” “I must be about my Father’s business...”***

We live in a fatherless world. Paul said to the church at Corinth - 1 Corinthians 4:15 (NKJV)
“For though you might have ten thousand instructors in Christ, yet you do not have many fathers; for in Christ Jesus I have begotten you through the gospel.”

Without fathers, the children are orphans, and without spiritual sons and daughters, the mantle of anointing and leadership falls to the ground

as a worthless object. Most of us in this room call ourselves:

- Apostle...
- Prophet...
- Evangelist...
- Pastor...
- Teacher...
- Bishop...

What we really are is overseers of orphanages.

PARENT/CHILD

RELATIONSHIPS

Relationships are a basic theme in Scripture.

For instance we could name:

- Moses and Joshua...
- Elijah and Elisha...
- Jesus and the disciples...
- Paul and Barnabas...
- Paul and Timothy...

All of these relationships were basic Father/Son relationships.

Paul mentions this kind of covenant relationship when he said, ***“For this cause shall a man leave his father and mother...”***

It is a covenantal alignment between people, with God as a participating third party.

When God “**joins**” people together in covenant and agreement, we see a unique sense of:

- Common vision...
- Common perspective...
- Common destiny...

The Greek word for “**join**” is “*proskolloō*” and means, “*to glue; or cement together.*” It is translated in the King James Bible as cleave or keep company.

What are the benefits of being joined to a Spiritual Father or Mother?

- Mutual identity... (My dad's dogs look at me like, "*sounds like him but doesn't look like him*")
- Common perception... (Seeing things alike – Seeing things through each-other's eyes)
- Common agenda... (Generational blessing)
- Harmony in judgment... (Becoming close enough to a spiritual authority that when judging a matter, one can hear what the Father/Mother would say about it)

This covenant relationship is characterized by:

- Honor...
- Loyalty...

- Commitment...

Within this kind of covenant relationship we find:

- Acceptance...
- Approval...
- Empowerment...
- Promotion...

A father/son relationship does not just happen. It must be an intentional agreement, a mutually entered covenantal bond, whereby both parties embrace rights, responsibilities, and privileges that are exclusive of others.

(The son must ask – The father must accept)

Such relationships:

- Establish longevity...
- Expands a vision exponentially...
- Provide durability of Kingdom initiatives...
- Extend ministries generationally...
- The potential for Kingdom increase is multiplied greatly...

Too many hard-won victories of the past have had to be refought because the legacy of spiritual Fathers/Mothers was lost.

Without spiritual children to inherit vision and legacy, a spiritual parents heritage will most certainly be swallowed up by time and the ground.

REWARDS AND RESPONSIBILITIES

There are six major benefits which accrue to the Son/Daughter from the Parent/Child, relationship:

- Identification... From the beginning, the Son/Daughter becomes identified with the Parent. Identification marks the child as an heir of their parents possessions, and a joint-heir with all those who are Sons/Daughters.
- Information... The spiritual parent brings knowledge and wisdom, insight and understanding to the relationship. They bring hard won principles and core values to

the relationship which can, and must be instilled into the life of the Son/Daughter.

- Inspiration... In addition to expanding the insight and vision of a spiritual Son/Daughter, the spiritual parent must also motivate and inspire their children. This is not an easy task. Often, the child comes to the parent in a state of personal disarray. They may be filled with vision, but lack clarity. They may come with emotional or moral baggage which must be unpacked and corrected. It is incumbent on the spiritual parent to be an exemplary model for the spiritual Son/Daughter to follow. The parent becomes the biggest fan of the child.

- Impartation... When a Son/Daughter is received by a Spiritual Parent, they come under the Parent's anointing and influence. As a result, the Parent begins to impart their own spiritual personality and character to the child. What the Parent does, the Child becomes engaged in. Their streams of ministry begin to flow together. Some would say the Child receives the Spiritual Parents DNA.

- Inheritance... Spiritual Fathers/Mothers bring a heritage, a legacy of ministry, to the relationship. Immediately upon becoming a Son/Daughter, the spiritual child becomes a partaker of the full inheritance of their parents. The child doesn't take over the parent's ministry. Rather, they partake of their parent's ministry in ways others cannot. With time, their identity with their parent's, influences others to see them much as they see the parent (Mom and Dad Goodwin's spiritual children are easily identifiable).

- Intimacy... The bond between a spiritual Father/Son Mother/Daughter grows into total trust and transparency. Weaknesses are confronted with pathways to strength.

Benefits to the Father/Mother:

Three benefits that accrue to the Father/Mother include:

- Assistance... As the relationship takes on the quality of a working covenant, the Father/Mother begins to receive meaningful assistance in accomplishing their vision. Elisha washed the hands of Elijah. (Note: 2 Kings 3:1)

Joshua served Moses faithfully, and at the time of Moses passing, he was positioned to become the leader of the nation.

Spiritual children become the inheritors of the mantle, the ones God uses to extend and expand the vision.

- Perspective... Fathers/Mothers who turn to their spiritual children are blessed with perspective otherwise unavailable to them as they grow older. Being close to a fresh perspective, allows the vision to transition into more than if the Father/Mother had held it alone.
- Continuity... The presence of a true Son/Daughter lends permanence and stability. The parent can rest in the fact that if he/she is incapacitated or dies, their vision will continue through their spiritual children. It is only what a person leaves in the next generation that truly makes a difference.

Let me close with this:

What counts in life and ministry is not what we finish (Which we have been programmed to believe), but who we start!